

Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority (Traffic Department)

Minutes of the Meeting held on 13th August 2024 at 14:15Hrs. with representatives of Empty Container Yard (ECY) operators, Transport Association, Shipping line Association and CFS Association regarding streamlining the operations at Empty Container Yards

Chairman, JNPA has chaired the meeting. List of the attendees present in the meeting is attached.

At the outset, the Chairman, JNPA welcomed all the participants.

1. Dy. General Manager (Traffic), informed that meeting with ECY operators was held at JNPA on 12/08/2024 and displayed the proposed draft of Standard Operating Procedure(SOP) for Streamlining the Operations at Empty Container Yards. He briefed the related issues in ECY operations and traffic congestions on roads nearby ECYs.
2. DGM(T) further informed that there is a separate module available in NLP-Marine (Sagar Setu) for empty container movement. All the stakeholders in the supply chain for empty container movement i. e. exporter / importer, shipping line, transporter, CHA, CFS and Empty Container Yard operator are to be registered in NLP- Marine. This will bring clarity in day to day operations. Chairman, JNPA assured to provide training to all stake holders for registration and implementing this module through NLP-Marine.
3. Representative of transport association informed that they have to pay the charges to ECY operators towards empty container handling charges which they are not supposed to pay. Also, Shipping Line representative informed that Deliver Order is addressed to importer for making the payment to ECY operators and bank details are also mentioned on the Delivery Order and hence, importer / exporter are only liable for making payments at ECYs.
4. As regards of clarity of payments, Chairman, JNPA directed to make all the transactions online only and the practice of cash payment should not be allowed after 31/08/2024. For this purpose, the Chairman advised to form an association of ECYs and have discussions with all concerned including BCBA. Chairman informed all forum that on discussions with all concerned about payments to be made at ECY, necessary advisory shall be issued to that effect. All the concerned shall ensure that there won't be cash transactions at ECY after 31.08.2024. Otherwise necessary action will be taken by JNPA and customs / GST authorities will be informed accordingly.
5. As a part of initiative by JNPA, Chairman suggested all ECY operators to form an Association for streamlining and coordinating the operation at their empty yards. Initially JNPA will be part of Association and extend any help/facilities if required.
6. To resolve the issues like traceability of container, clarity of payment, fatigue to drivers, detention of Tractor Trailer, offloading of container in case of congestion at yard, payment of damage container etc. raised by transport association, Chairman directed to ECY operators to prepare Standard Operating Procedure(SOP). The process used at Mundra may be replicated at JNPA.
7. In response, CFS Association representative suggested to bring all stake holders including BCBA on common platform.
8. After deliberations on above, Chairman directed to comply with following: -